

Alexander Caceres-Wright

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EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy: Computer Science and Engineering, University at Buffalo (SUNY), Buffalo, New York.

Expected Graduation: June 2028

Advisor: Dr. Kenneth Joseph

Research Areas: Computational Social Science; Large Language Models; Natural Language Processing

Master of Science: Computer Science and Engineering, University at Buffalo (SUNY), Buffalo, New York, June 2024

Bachelor of Arts: Cognitive Systems, University of British Columbia, Vancouver, Canada, May 2022

Minor: Psychology

SKILLS & TOOLS

Large Language Models: Llama, BERT

Data Science Tools: SQL, R, PostgreSQL, Firebase Realtime Database, Pyspark

Programming Languages: Python, Java, C++, C, Haskell, JavaScript

Tools: Git, Jupyter, Visual Studio, LaTeX, Flask, Pandas, Matplotlib

Languages: English (Fluent), Spanish (Fluent)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, cUBe Lab at the University at Buffalo, Buffalo, NY. June 2023 – Present

- Constructed tools for stance detection using Large Language Models applied to 15 million tweets from the 2020 US Presidential Election. Ran experiments to evaluate LLM prompts and parameters.
- Published peer-reviewed paper: A. Caceres-Wright et al., “Explicit Stance Detection in the Political Domain: A New Concept and Associated Dataset”, SBP-BRiMS 2024. **Runner Up: Best Student-Led Paper Award**
- Presented peer-reviewed poster: A. Caceres-Wright, G. Bunn, S. Shuster, and K. Joseph, “Who supports Bernie? Analyzing identity and ideological variation of Bernie supporters on Twitter”, IC2S2 2024.
- Investigating how individuals express identity online and how those who share identities speak about shared topics

Student Assistant, X-Lab at the University at Buffalo, Buffalo, NY. June 2023 – August 2023

- Researched and developed indices of interdisciplinarity using natural language processing
- Completed a literature search aiming to incorporate best previous results into our index

Research in Cognitive Systems, University of British Columbia, Vancouver, BC. August 2021 – January 2022

- Worked as a research assistant in the Center for Applied Moral Psychology (CAMP) to program a variation of the public goods game using the oTree framework
- Deployed this software to collect data from ~10 games of 4 players each
- Synthesized results and wrote a report of the findings in the context of relevant work

PUBLICATIONS

1. **A. Caceres-Wright**, N. Udhayasankar, G. Bunn, S. Shuster, and K. Joseph, “Explicit Stance Detection in the Political Domain: A New Concept and Associated Dataset”, 2024 International Conference on Social Computing, Behavioral-Cultural Modeling & Prediction and Behavior Representation (SBP-BRiMS)
 - **Runner Up: Best Student-Led Paper Award.**

PRESENTATIONS

1. **A. Caceres-Wright**, and K. Joseph, “Signals of Receptiveness in Discourse on Reddit over 10 Years”, *Poster Presentation*, Rethinking Persuasion: From Social Media to AI Systems Symposium, October 2026
2. **A. Caceres-Wright**, and K. Joseph, “Signals of Receptiveness in Discourse on Reddit over 10 Years”, *Oral Presentation*, 2026 Conference on Complex Systems (CCS), October 2026
3. **A. Caceres-Wright**, G. Bunn, S. Shuster, and K. Joseph, “Who supports Bernie? Analyzing identity and ideological variation of Bernie supporters on Twitter”, *Poster Presentation*, 2024 International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC2S2), July 2024

INVITED TALKS

1. Named Entity Recognition and Stance Detection using Large Language Models. Given to Center for Equitable AI & Machine Learning Systems (CEAMLS), Morgan State University, May 2026.
2. AI in Practice. Given to students in AI 104: Introduction to Computational Expression, University at Buffalo. April 2026.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, University at Buffalo. Buffalo, NY. January 2026 – May 2026

- Developed the first ever offering of *AI 104: Introduction to Computational Expression* alongside the professor
- Alongside regular TA duties I helped develop in class activities and other assessments
- Presented an invited lecture on AI in Practice, discussing common ways LLMs and other AI tools are used in industry

Teaching Assistant, University at Buffalo, Buffalo, NY. August 2025 – December 2025

- Facilitated learning for over 100 students enrolled in CSE 421/521: Operating Systems
- Guided students through two projects implementing operating system fundamentals
- Held weekly office hours to support student learning

Teaching Assistant, University of British Columbia, Vancouver, BC. January 2020 – December 2020

- Assisted in the delivery of three semesters of CPSC 210: Software Construction
- Duties included running labs, holding office hours, and grading assignments and exams
- Mentored ~30 students per semester as they worked on a semester-long project. Helped guide design and implementation, and helped debug issues, through weekly 1:1 meetings

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Data Analyst (Intern), Quanturisk Analytics Ltd, New York, NY, September 2024 – June 2025

- Joined the company while it was an early stage startup
- Curated high quality corporate dataset with quality controls
- Ran statistical analysis on financial data, used results to identify key financial metrics for further analysis
- Developed financial models to study corporate resilience to sustainability risk
- Created models to accurately predict missing corporate data when necessary
- Designed a matching algorithm to allow data from different sources to be accurately assigned to the correct entities

PROJECTS

Text-to-Speech Application for Low Resource Languages. Python, Huggingface, Transformers

- Created a Text-to-Speech (TTS) system for a low resource Indigenous Language from the Amazon
- Experimented with several different approaches and models, compared end results, and wrote a report summarizing methods and findings

Simulating Trading Models. Python, QuantConnect, Zipline, Pandas, Matplotlib

- Developed simple stock trading models based on various technical indicators such as the Relative Strength Index
- Backtested the models using various frameworks on the stocks of the S&P 500

Museum Interactive Scavenger Hunt. Python, Flask, Firebase Realtime Database, Javascript, CSS

- Implemented a full-stack application for the Niagara Aerospace Museum for visitors to complete a scavenger hunt
- Allows curators to enter or edit clues and exhibits, and visitors to customize the length and difficulty of their hunt

Financial Literacy Application: UB Hacking: Fall 2022 (Hackathon, 1st Place). SQL, JavaFX

- Won first place prize with a prototype JavaFX application aimed at centralizing financial information new immigrants may find useful, such as on banking, Free Application for Federal Student Aid (FAFSA), housing, etc.
- Prompted users with a questionnaire to tailor information they were presented. Stored survey responses in a MySQL database along with a username and password for later retrieval

Pintos Simple Operating System C

- Developed part of an operating system as part of a course
- Implemented several scheduling algorithms, priority donation, memory management, as well as some user interaction

Text Chat Application C++

- Implemented both server and client side methods such as sending and receiving messages, and blocking other clients
- Created functionality to analyze server side statistics including IP addresses, and ports of logged in clients, and tracking of number of sent and received messages

Modeling Internet Packet Protocols C++

- Implemented several packet transmission protocols such as the selective repeat and Go-Back-N
- Analyzed performance of the protocols via testing and summarized findings in a report

Lossy Image Compression C++

- Compressed images using a space partition tree which minimizes color variability across partitions
- Precomputed color statistics for each region

Book Management System. Java, JavaFX

- Allowed users to enter and edit details such as title, author, subject, and length
- Saved and loaded data for use across sessions
- Implemented both a command line and graphical user interface

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Reviewer, 2026 AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media (ICWSM)

Reviewer, 2025 International Conference on Social Computing, Behavioral-Cultural Modeling & Prediction and Behavior Representation (SBP-BRiMS).

Reviewer, 2025 International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC2S2)

Reviewer, 2024 International Conference on Social Computing, Behavioral-Cultural Modeling & Prediction and Behavior Representation (SBP-BRiMS).

UNIVERSITY SERVICE

Mentor, AI Innovation Design Challenge: Innovating for a Brighter Tomorrow, University at Buffalo. October 3, 2026

Student Host Coordinator, Artificial Intelligence and Society Department, University at Buffalo. October 2025-Present

- Coordinated faculty candidate interviews by liaising between faculty schedulers and PhD students to ensure strong attendance at candidate meetings
- Managed meeting logistics including catering arrangements in collaboration with department administration
- Trained successor coordinators and served as liaison between administrative staff and student volunteers

Mentor, AI For Good Design Challenge. University at Buffalo, October 25–26, 2025

Alumni Mentor, Cognitive Systems Society, Tri-Mentoring Program. September 2022–Present

AWARDS & HONORS

Runner Up: Best Student-Led Paper Award. SBP-BRiMS, September 18–20, 2024

First Place Prize, M&T Bank's An Innovative Way to Promote Financial Understanding and Well Being Award. UB Hacking: Fall 2022 (Hackathon). November 5–6, 2022

Outstanding International Student Award. University of British Columbia. Academic Year 2017–2018

Second Degree Black Belt, Kyokushin Karate. Ken Wa Kan Karate, New York City. Achieved March 15, 2015

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIP

Member, Association for the Advancement of Artificial Intelligence (AAAI). September 2025–Present

Member, Association for Computing Machinery (ACM). January 2023–Present